

Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

Enterprise AI Commercialisation & Value Engineering

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Work permit: EU · Switzerland · English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

Zurich (2020-present) · London (2015-2020) · Paris (2013-2014)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Financial services professional with a decade of international experience across London, Zurich and Paris. Early career in FIG Debt Capital Markets at Societe Generale, covering DACH and Benelux financial institutions, followed by investment and financing work at a London family office. Since 2020, based in Zurich delivering enterprise AI strategy and workflow programmes for regulated financial-services organisations at Accenture. Currently leading the strategy, economics and pilot delivery of an AI-enabled regulatory-change workflow at a leading European reinsurer. Prior work spans FINMA regulatory reporting, OeNB central-bank audit, and NFR AI practice leadership and go-to-market across the DACH region. CFA charterholder.

EXPERIENCE

> Accenture, Zurich Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- Strategy, economics, roadmap and pilot delivery for an AI-enabled regulatory-change workflow at a leading European reinsurer, covering DORA, NIS2, EU AI Act and Solvency II.
- AI use-case and workflow shaping across RCSA, TPRM and regulatory change: translating business and control requirements into executable pilot designs with technical teams.
- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local AI and NFR practice, defining go-to-market for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Led origination and end-to-end delivery of a FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme at a leading Swiss insurer, including Databricks data-platform implementation.
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, drawing on capital-markets experience across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Coordination across CRO, COO, risk, data, technology, governance, and regulatory stakeholders in regulated financial-services environments.

• Single Family Office, London Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial, growth-stage environment.

Societe Generale, **London** Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG | DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

Catalina, **Paris** Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

- Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.
- Statistical analysis of transaction data.
- Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.
- Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Workflow Platform | View repository

Public technical demonstrator

- Platform demonstrator built around multiple AI agent workflows for different NFR domains, with a shared knowledge graph, document intelligence, human approval gates and enterprise integration patterns. Built as an enterprise-oriented demonstrator of what a shared platform architecture looks like relative to isolated pilots.
- Commercial relevance: Individual AI use cases tend to stay isolated from each other. This platform shows what it looks like when they share a knowledge graph, common agent infrastructure, and consistent approval patterns: the architecture of a platform rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
- Synthetic demonstration. No client data, no client credentials. Not a production deployment.

DORA Article 12 AI Control Line | View repository

Enterprise workflow demonstrator

- A fully functional AI workflow demonstrator built around a real regulatory requirement (DORA Article 12). Uses synthetic and anonymised data throughout. Takes a regulatory input through AI-generated control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy-engine verification, compliance documentation, human approval gates, and a complete traceable evidence chain.
- Commercial relevance: Demonstrates the full architecture of an enterprise AI workflow: model integration (OpenAI o3 for regulatory reasoning, GPT-4o for infrastructure, GPT-4o-mini for documentation), an 11-state machine for end-to-end traceability, and human approval gates at every consequential step. Built using only synthetic and anonymised data.
- Public prototype using synthetic and anonymised data. No client systems, credentials or confidential information. Integration patterns are illustrative.

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator | View repository

Public executive decision tool

- Interactive tool for modelling the full economics of an enterprise AI platform: model selection and routing, token costs, cloud vs. sovereign vs. on-premise hosting, shared infrastructure costs, governance overhead, and net value projections. Built for executive decision-making and proposal development.
- Commercial relevance: Useful for buyers and architects who need to model the full economics of an AI platform investment: not only capability but also what shared infrastructure and governance overhead do to unit economics.
- Interactive public demonstrator using illustrative planning assumptions. Not a client tool or production system.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder
CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments 2014 – 2015
Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University
Cum laude · 8.5/10
Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration 2011 – 2014
Rotterdam School of Management
Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercialisation and market building

AI go-to-market · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · C-suite engagement · proposition development · pilot commercialisation · partner and ecosystem strategy · adoption and expansion · financial and revenue modelling

Enterprise AI value engineering

use-case prioritisation · workflow and operating-model design · business-case development · pilot scope and success criteria · model and workflow evaluation · human oversight · governance and controls · production-readiness planning

Applied technical fluency

agent workflow concepts · API and enterprise integration requirements · data and knowledge architecture concepts · model evaluation and routing · human approval patterns · AI-assisted prototyping · cloud deployment patterns

Financial services

FIG and capital markets · Non-Financial Risk · RCSA and TPRM · DORA and AI governance · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · investment and financing analysis